

The Power of the One Pager

Investors decide whether to take your call in less than 15 seconds. The one-pager is the document that has to survive that test.

A pitch deck wins the room. The one-pager wins the chance to be in the room. It travels in inboxes, sits on phone screens, and gets forwarded between partners — usually without you in the conversation.

Drawing on Pitchbird's work with thousands of founders, this guide distils the eight non-negotiables every one-pager needs, the four upgrades that turn competent into memorable, and the design principles that respect how investors actually read.

In the following pages, you'll learn:

- The 8 elements every one-pager must have
- The 4 high-leverage additions to consider
- How investors scan — and what to put where their eyes go
- When the one-pager helps and when it limits you

Magdalena Reith · Founder, Pitchbird

“Well-designed one-pagers turn cold inboxes into conversations that change everything.”



01: Why it matters

One sheet of paper. One decision.

The one-pager is the door, not the room. Done well, it earns you the meeting. Done badly, it earns you silence — and you'll never know which line lost you the deal.

A pitch deck wins the room. The one-pager wins the chance to be in the room. It travels in inboxes, sits on phone screens, and gets forwarded between partners — usually without you in the conversation.

That means every element has to do double duty: **introduce, intrigue, and stand on its own.**

32%

of decision-makers drop off after 15 seconds of reading a one-pager. The first impression is the only impression.

SOURCE · STORYDOC, 2024



Treat the one-pager as the most-circulated document you will ever make. Because it is.

02: The framework

The eight non-negotiables

If a one-pager misses any of these, it is incomplete. Treat this as the checklist before you send anything.

01

Company name & logo

Identity is the anchor. Investors know who they're dealing with before they read a single word.

02

Contact information

The most-skipped basic. If they can't reach you in one click, the document did nothing.

03

Company profile

A short, informative introduction — what you are, who you serve, why you exist.

04

Business idea

Describe the core concept in one tight sentence. No jargon, no hedging.

05

Unique selling proposition

What makes this venture distinct from the next ten emails in the inbox.

06

Roadmap & timeline

Graphically show where the business is going and when. Visual beats prose here.

07

Investment ask

The amount needed, the structure (one-time or tranches), and the deadline. Specific.

08

Investment highlights

The three or four reasons this allocation pays back. Punchy, not vague.



03: Beyond the basics

Add these if you have the space

The four below are the most common upgrades. Together, they turn a competent one-pager into a memorable one.

Problem



Frame the pain in market terms before you frame yourself.

Investors connect with the problem first. Make them feel it before you sell the cure.

Solution



Show how your business removes that pain. Two lines, max.

Lead with the outcome — not the mechanism. Save the how for the deck.

Traction



Prove customers want it. Revenue, signups, LOIs — whichever you have.

Proof beats promise. One data point trumps a paragraph of optimism.

Market



Who you sell to, and the competitive landscape they live in.

Investors want a beachhead, not 'everyone'. Show the wedge first.

04: Design principles

How investors actually read it



Content is king

Clarity first. Strong narrative — problem, solution, impact. Hierarchy via headings, sub-heads, and bullets that guide the eye.



Visually appealing

Clean composition, generous white space, strategic visuals over walls of text. Colour evokes brand, not chaos.



Remember your audience

Investors scan, not read. Lead with what helps their decision. Professional, confident tone throughout.



Call to action

End with one specific ask. 'Schedule a 20-minute call.' Not 'we'd love to chat sometime.'



05: Trade-offs

What it gives you — and what it can't

STRENGTHS

Respects the investor's time — and signals you respect it too.

Forces sharper thinking. If it doesn't fit on a page, the idea isn't focused yet.

Travels well — easy to forward, print, remember.

LIMITATIONS

Brevity is unforgiving. Every missing detail is a potential rejection.

Hard to write alone — outside eyes catch what founder-bias hides.

Not a substitute for the full deck. It is the door, not the room.



The one-pager is brutal in the right way. If your business doesn't fit on the page, the business isn't sharp yet.

**Want a Pitchbird review of
your one-pager?**

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